Build and publish the shared automation core

Architects maintain the core, protect existing keywords and publish release versions.

WHAT ARCHITECTS MAINTAIN

Framework source project

src/main/java	Reusable steps, hooks, drivers, actions and assertions
src/main/resources	Shared defaults and schemas; never credentials
src/test	The library's own validation tests; not included in the core JAR

REUSABLE AUTOMATION CAPABILITIES

Web + mobile web

Playwright browser actions
Viewport and device profiles

Native mobile

Appium driver lifecycle
Android + iOS app actions

API

HTTP requests and responses
Status, payload and schema checks

Database

JDBC connections and queries
Data and persistence checks

PDF

Text, metadata and forms
Rendering and visual checks

Performance

JMeter profiles and requests
Metrics and threshold checks

FOUNDATION SHARED BY EVERY AUTOMATION TYPE

Keywords + lifecycle

Reusable Cucumber steps + hooks

Configuration + selectors

YAML defaults + element mapping

Evidence + cleanup

Assertions, reports + resource cleanup

Package boundary

IN: compiled core, reusable steps and safe defaults.

OUT: Testers' tests and run reports.

commit

HOW THE CORE REACHES TESTERS

1. Azure Repos

Reviewed source, pull requests and release tags
Architects review changes to shared keywords

2. Azure Pipelines

Unit, integration and test-project checks
Windows/macOS; Maven/Gradle sample projects
Build JAR + POM; publish release version

publish once per version

3. Azure Artifacts

Maven feed: versioned JAR + package POM
automation-core : 1.2.3 (example)
Release notes; tester read access

resolve release version

4. Tester-owned projects

Pin the release version in pom.xml
Upgrade explicitly; no forced version updates

Create project tests. Reuse the published core.

Testers own src/test and project configuration; the shared framework arrives as a dependency.

CONNECT THE PROJECT TO THE RELEASE PACKAGE

1. Project pom.xml

Dependency: automation-core
Release: 1.2.3 (example) | scope: test
Repository: Azure Artifacts Maven feed

2. Maven resolution

Feed authentication: settings.xml or CI
Credentials remain outside the repository
Read access to the release package feed

3. Azure Artifacts

Returns the requested release
Compiled JAR and dependency metadata
No source checkout required for use

download

WRITE TESTS IN YOUR OWN PROJECT

Tester-owned files

```
pom.xml
src/test/resources/
  features/*.feature
  elements/, config/, data/
src/test/java/
  runners/
  custom/   (application-specific steps)
```

loads

4. Cucumber runner

Loads project features and data
Uses published hooks + reusable steps
Adds application-specific glue if needed

Downloaded framework JAR

Cached in the local .m2 repository
Available on the test classpath
Core source is not copied into src/main

5. Execute the selected automation

Web + mobile web | native mobile | API | database | PDF | performance
Shared core actions run against the project's authorized environment

6. Review results and evidence

Scenario reports, screenshots, video, PDF checks and performance results as applicable

CORE IS REUSED, NOT COPIED

Create tests; do not duplicate or edit dependency code.

Upgrade by changing the release version in pom.xml.